



Scale Play

UltraTech's 200 mtpa milestone underlines how manufacturing scale, operational discipline and cleaner energy are shaping its next phase of growth

BY KRISHNA GOPALAN

IN MID-APRIL this year, UltraTech Cement Ltd, an Aditya Birla Group company, crossed the 200 million tonnes per annum capacity mark. Apart from being the largest player in India, this made UltraTech the largest cement company in the world outside China.

The scale of this achievement can be gauged from the fact that it is now almost twice the cement capacity of the United States and more than the EU's overall capacity.

168 | At an event to announce this milestone, Group Chairman Kumar Mangalam Birla highlighted that, of the 200 mtpa capacity, about 110 mtpa has come through greenfield and brownfield expansions, with

the other 90 mtpa added through buyouts, most notably L&T's cement business, Jaypee, Binani, Century, Kesoram and India Cements.

One aspect that Birla spoke of in some detail was scale, which he said reveals itself in four ways: in impact, reach, reliability and responsibility. Over time, UltraTech has become better at delivering on these counts, evident in its strong brand name and wide reach across the country. Manufacturing has played a key role in making that possible.

To break that down further, the company's manufacturing philosophy, according to its annual report, is anchored in a simple belief: trust is built through consistent performance, responsible growth and meaningful partnerships. Through systematic capacity expansions over the past few years, UltraTech has strengthened its operational excellence and set new industry benchmarks.

"Today, UltraTech leads the way in driving energy efficiency, scaling renewable energy, and embedding digital innovations. These efforts progressively reduce our carbon intensity while enhancing our reliability and cost competitiveness," states the annual report.

Manufacturing, for the cement major, has a multifaceted approach. The focus is on maximising opera-



Kumar
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UltraTech
Cement Ltd



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tional efficiency even as the shift to cleaner energy, alternative fuels and waste heat recovery continues.

To Birla, 200 mtpa is only a marker and not a destination. "With a target of 240 mtpa by FY28 at an investment of ₹16,000 crore already in motion, the path ahead is firmly underway. India stands at a defining juncture, where choices made over the next decade will shape its infrastructure for generations," he said. **BT**

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